

TABLE 8.5 : LITERACY RATES OF THE POPULATION AGED 10 YEARS AND OVER BY DISTRICTS
1963 AND 1971

	1963			1971		
	T	M	F	T	M	F
Sri Lanka	769	856	673	785	865	709
Colombo	884	924	839	884	919	844
Gampaha. Kalutara	826	888	761	832	886	777
Kandy	711	830	581	742	842	639
Matale	709	832	573	734	827	633
Nuwara Eliya	627	792	446	639	789	483
Galle	802	873	735	826	881	772
Matara	742	837	652	784	856	714
Hambantota	683	808	550	736	827	639
Jaffna	847	891	803	827	863	792
Mannar	756	828	659	759	824	680
Vavuniya	803	860	716	768	818	699
Kuathio Batticaloa	629	753	492	570	664	467
Amparai	621	765	435	644	764	507
Trincomalee	734	825	601	681	764	576
Kurunegala	784	874	684	812	880	740
Puttalam	847	898	791	837	880	791
Anuradhapura	751	859	611	760	842	662
Polonnaruwa	761	839	639	781	842	696
Badulla	613	767	443	652	783	515
Moneragala	600	731	433	651	752	528
Ratnapura	682	801	545	716	811	610
Kegalle	748	847	642	784	862	703

8.7 School Attendance

The information on school attendance obtained from those aged 5 to 24 years at the 1971 Census related to whether the person attended school or other educational institution during the two month period prior to the Census, that is August-September. The number reported as attending school by broad age groups is shown in Table 8.6. This data is compared with the annual data on the number of pupils enrolled in schools collected by the Ministry of Education. It will be observed that there are differences in the two sets of figures. In the first instance, the two sets of data are related to different points of time. Secondly, while the Census data are based on regular attendance during a specified period, the Ministry data are in respect of students enrolled in the Registers.

TABLE 8.6 : COMPARISON OF 1971 CENSUS FIGURES ON SCHOOL ATTENDANCE WITH
EDUCATION MINISTRY FIGURES OF SCHOOL ENROLLMENT

Age	1971 Number attending school	Education Ministry figures. No. enrolled in registers (March 1971)
Total 5-24 years	2,719,143	2,802,336 X
5-14 years	2,141,671	2,406,201 X
15-24 years	578,072	396,135

females & found in Batticaloa districts